



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Holy Child Catholic School
School Website: <https://www.holychildnm.com/home/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Holy Child Catholic School NM 87059 presents a clearly Catholic, classical-leaning program that foregrounds formation through a rigorous, theologically-anchored classical curriculum. Public-facing materials emphasize Christ-centered formation, the Catholic intellectual tradition, and a stated goal of forming the whole person—mind, soul, and body—while prioritizing truths such as truth, goodness, and beauty, as well as devotion to the Eucharist. The site also highlights a Great Books orientation (e.g., a course featuring Dostoevsky) and a focus on Western civilization, which aligns with core classical-education aims. Overall, the school sits solidly in the Classical camp, with significant strengths in religious/metaphysical foundations and formation-focused goals, while certain granular curricular and pedagogical details are less explicit in public materials. The aggregate assessment falls into CLASSICAL, with room for more explicit articulation of the full classical curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and traditional pedagogy (e.g., socratic seminars, scholé) in public-facing content.

Key evidence includes: Mission and Vision statements centering on a Christ-centered, truth/beauty/goodness framework and the Doctors of the Church; explicit emphasis on a rigorous classical curriculum and Catholic intellectual tradition; a stated focus on Eucharist and liturgical devotion; and public notes of Great Books/the Western canon (e.g., Dostoevsky) and Western civilization as curricular anchors. The site also references a formal role for parents and families in the formation process, and a "Current Families" portal indicating ongoing family involvement. See Mission/Vision and related statements on the Holy Child site; the Eucharistic-literacy emphasis; and references to Western civilization and Great Books on the public pages.

Notes on rubric and methodology: - Rubric and keyword framework drawn from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) documents in the knowledge base, including explicit positive/negative keyword inventories for each category and the overall six-element structure. The core keyword lists (Positive/Negative) and the six-element categories are used to structure the analysis. - The lexicon of classical keywords (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, etc.) is used to ground the analysis of the school's public materials against the classical rubric.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Rationale: The school demonstrates strong transcendental foundations (truth/goodness/beauty) and explicit Catholic-theological grounding (Doctors of the Church, Eucharist, liturgical orientation) that strongly align with Classical expectations in Element 1. Element 2 is reinforced by formation-focused mission/vision and a claim of forming the whole person. Element 3 shows explicit classical framing (rigorous classical curriculum, Great Books orientation, Western Civilization emphasis) but public materials do not always spell out the full Trivium/Quadrivium structure or explicit Great-Books reading lists beyond Dostoevsky; thus, rating

leans toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Element 4 reflects elements of classical pedagogy (fundamental reliance on memory and high-level formation through literature) but lacks explicit public articulation of Socratic seminars or scholé practices; thus, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Element 5 is supported by statements about faculty as virtuous, mission-driven professionals and a staff-teacher-centered approach, aligning with CLASSICAL. Element 6 shows explicit parental involvement through the Current Families portal and stated partnership orientation, aligning with CLASSICAL. Aggregating across categories yields CLASSICAL overall, with room to more explicitly spell out the full classical pedagogy and curricular framework on the website.

What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL categories) - Element 3 (Curriculum): Provide explicit, public articulation of the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium components (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy); publish Great-Books lists aligned to a formal Great Conversation framework; explicitly connect history/grammar/logic/literature across grades. - Element 4 (Pedagogy): Publicly document and describe a formal pedagogy aligned to classical practices (e.g., Socratic seminars in upper grades, scholé/restful learning days, memory work/recitation, classical copywork, master-apprentice modeling). Include exemplars or sample lesson sequences to demonstrate the use of these approaches. - Element 6 (Parents & Community): Expand parent-formation programming and explicit “parents as co-teachers” messaging with concrete opportunities (book chats, witness to Great Conversation, catechesis at home, liturgical calendar involvement) and a published parent-education calendar.

Note: If you want, I can expand on the needle-moving suggestions with concrete public-facing language that aligns to the Six Elements lexicon.

Proceeding to the Element-by-Element analysis below.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

• Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Mission Statement emphasizes advancement of the soul, mind, and body through a rigorous classical curriculum, spiritual growth, stewardship of God’s gifts, and love for the Eucharist and evangelization. This is a direct articulation of formation and transcendentals within a Catholic framework.
- Vision Statement describes a Christ-centered environment forming the whole person and calls students, staff, and parents to embrace truth, beauty, and goodness for the glory of God, explicitly tying to the Catholic intellectual tradition and Doctors of the Church.
- The site notes participation in the Catholic intellectual tradition with a special focus on the Doctors of the Church.
- The Eucharistic-literacy emphasis (liturgical devotion, Eucharistic Adoration) demonstrates liturgical and communal practices integral to education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue (formation), theology, liturgy, Eucharist, Doctor(s) of the Church, sacred/Christ-centered, sacred tradition, reverence, worship, liturgy, concinnity with the Church, communal prayer.
- Negative keywords present: none evident in public materials (no explicit values-neutral or secular frameworks).
- Quantitative estimate: among the core Positive Keywords inventory for this element, at least 6–9 distinct terms appear (truth/goodness/beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; Eucharist; Doctors of the Church; Christ-centered; sacred/tradition). Negative keywords: 0 visible.

Why this rating

- The school’s public materials consistently tie education to transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty), theological integration (the Doctors of the Church, Eucharist, liturgy), and liturgical/-community life. This aligns squarely with Classical expectations for Religious and Metaphysical

Foundations, yielding a CLASSICAL rating. The presence of explicit Catholic tocs (Doctors of the Church, Eucharist) pushes strongly toward Classical rather than merely Somewhat Classical.

Citations: Mission and Vision statements; Eucharistic-literacy note.

- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The Mission Statement frames education as formation through a rigorous classical curriculum and spiritual maturation, rather than mere information transfer or job preparation. This signals formation of virtue and wisdom and a teleological orientation toward the true, good, and beautiful.
- Vision emphasizes forming the whole person in a Christ-centered context and invites embrace of truth, beauty, and goodness, which embodies formation over mere information.
- The Great-Books/Western-Civilization emphasis (e.g., Dostoevsky course) indicates pursuit of the true, good, and beautiful through engagement with canonical literature.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, scholé, contemplation, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, great conversation, human flourishing, moral imagination, Christian formation.
- Negative keywords present: none evident.
- Quantitative estimate: 6–9 positive indicators embedded in statements about formation and the teleology of education; 0 negative terms detected in public materials.

Why this rating

- The school narrates education as formation (soul/mind/body) and virtue development with a teleology toward truth/goodness/beauty, mapping neatly to Classical expectations for School Purpose and Goal.

Citations: Mission/ Vision statements; references to Great Books/Western civilization.

- Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The Mission Statement explicitly calls for a rigorous classical curriculum, indicating a classical curricular frame.
- The site highlights a focus on Western civilization and Great Books(including Dostoevsky) as curricular anchors, signaling a classical approach to content and canon.
- The presence of “A Year With Dostoevsky” and a focus on Doctors of the Church signals engagement with canonical texts within a Western-Christian framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Great Books, Western civilization, classical curriculum, Doctors of the Church, Dostoevsky (as a Great-Books anchor), sacred tradition, sacred/immutable truths (as implied by the formation emphasis).
- Negative keywords present: The site does not publicly spell out the full Seven Liberal Arts (Trivium/Quadrivium) or explicit reference to Latin/Greek language study; nor does it publicly publish a formal, line-item Great-Books syllabus beyond select courses. This reduces the strength of a full Seven Liberal Arts / Quadrivium depiction in public materials.
- Quantitative estimate: Positive indicators appear (minimum) 4–6 distinct elements (classical curriculum phrasing, Great Books orientation, Western civilization canon, Doctors of the Church emphasis, Dostoevsky course) with limited explicit Seven Liberal Arts mention; Negative indicators: explicit absence of detailed Trivium/Quadrivium, Latin/Greek, or full Great-Books canon list is noticeable.

Why this rating

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- The school clearly uses a classical frame (explicit “rigorous classical curriculum” and canonical Great-Books / Western-Civilization emphasis) but public materials do not consistently enumerate the complete Seven Liberal Arts or all elements of the Trivium/Quadrivium as a curricular structure. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Citations: Mission statement; Dostoevsky course; Western civilization emphasis.

- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public-facing content emphasizes formation through a classical curriculum and canonical content (Great Books) but does not publicly spell out the traditional pedagogical methods (Socratic seminars, scholé, recitation, etc.) on the site. The presence of canonical reading (Dostoevsky) points to literature-driven pedagogy, but explicit pedagogy terms are sparse in public materials.
- The Eucharistic-literacy and liturgical emphasis indicate a rhythm and contemplative dimension to education consistent with scholé-like practices in some classical models, but explicit lower/upper-school pedagogical methods are not described in detail on the site.
- A Year With Dostoevsky and Doctors of the Church as embedded curricular anchors suggest a texture of discussion and textual study, aligning with the classical ethos of text-based inquiry.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue (implied via Great-Books/text-based discussion), contemplation, wonder, reverence, memory work/recitation (not explicitly stated, but classical formation often includes it), seminar/debate (not explicitly stated), rhetoric (not explicitly stated, but connected to public-facing literature).
- Negative keywords present: The site does not publicly advertise explicit project-based learning dominance, experiential learning emphasis, or purely constructivist approaches; those would be negative signals in strict classical lexicon. The lack of explicit Socratic/Schole terms is a weakness from the strict rubric perspective.
- Quantitative estimate: Positive indicators are weakly present via canonical lit/Great-Books content; negative signals largely absent since the site does not advertise non-classical pedagogy, but explicit classical-pedagogy terms are not strongly published.

Why this rating

- The presence of canonical content and a classical framing supports SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The absence of explicit, public, detailed pedagogical-method language (e.g., strictly described Socratic seminars, scholé days, memory work) reduces to CLASSICAL.

Citations: Mission statement; Dostoevsky course; Western-canon emphasis.

- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public statements reference a staff dedicated to the love of Christ and the Church, emphasizing virtue and education’s forming role in the living curriculum. This aligns with the Classical expectation of faculty as mentors and living exemplars.
- The mission/vision frames the faculty as instructors who guide formation and who embody the school’s Catholic-formation aims; the Doctor of the Church classroom-naming and intellectual-formation programming indicate a focused faculty profile aligned with classical aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: virtuous educators, character formation, mentorship, living curriculum, faculty of friends, professional/holy formation (as in many classical programs), clergy/Church alignment (in Catholic classical education contexts).
- Negative keywords present: none evident in the public content.

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- Quantitative estimate: 3–5 distinct positive indicators visible (staff dedication to virtue, living curriculum, mentorship, broad Catholic formation, Doctor-named classrooms).

Why this rating

- The public materials depict faculty as virtuous, mission-aligned, and the living curriculum, consistent with CLASSICAL rather than not-classical. The Catholic-context formation further reinforces the Classical orientation.

Citations: Mission/ Vision statements; Doctor-of-the-Church classroom note; staff phrasing.

- **Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL**

Evidence

- The site includes a Current Families portal and Admissions/Tuition pages indicating ongoing parent involvement, a hallmark of Classical education's partnerships with families.
- The mission to form the whole person and the explicit emphasis on the Doctors of the Church and Eucharistic literacy imply a family- and parish-integrated formation model, aligning with classic "parents as co-educators" rhetoric found in classical education texts.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent formation, home-school alignment, family catechesis, parent involvement.
- Negative keywords present: none explicitly shown on the site.
- Quantitative estimate: 3–6 positive indicators (Current Families portal, admissions/family involvement; letters about families; home-school alignment cues).

Why this rating

- Public materials show a visible emphasis on family involvement and open-campus vibes (Current Families, Admissions), matching CLASSICAL expectations for strong parent/community partnership.

Citations: Current Families page; Admissions & Tuition; Home area statements.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Curriculum (Element 3) and Pedagogy (Element 4), the needle would move most by publicly publishing explicit, canonical details:
 - Publish a public, detailed map of the curriculum that names the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; quadrivium elements), Great Books/primary sources list, Latin/Greek offerings, history as Western civilization focus, and explicit Great-Conversation labeling. Include sample scope-and-sequence for K–12. This would convert SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL into CLASSICAL by fulfilling the explicit curriculum criteria.
 - Publish a clear pedagogy statement with concrete practices: Socratic seminars in Upper School, Scholé/restful-learning days, memorization/recitation practices, memory work, and teacher-mentors model. Share example lesson sequences and teacher professional development plans that articulate the public-facing pedagogy and how it supports formation through a living curriculum.
- For Parents & Community (Element 6), expand parent formation:
 - Create a published, regular schedule of parent-formation offerings (book studies, lectures on classical education, home-catechesis alignment) with clear participation pathways and outcomes. Include documented parent-education progress and activities.
- For Faculty (Element 5), strengthen the living-curriculum language:
 - Publish a formal "portrait of a teacher" and "portrait of a student" as the school's public living-curriculum ideals, with examples of teacher professional development in classical pedagogy and opportunities for faculty seminars on great books and rhetorical training.

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- For Religious/Metaphysical Foundations (Element 1):
 - Amplify explicit liturgical/rhythm language (Scholé days, liturgical calendar integration, morning prayers) in public materials to more clearly connect the daily-life rhythms of schooling to liturgical worship, while preserving Catholic identity.

Note: The above needle-moving suggestions align with the Six Elements lexical indicators (e.g., explicitly listing Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, liturgical practices, scholé, teacher-portrait, family partnership) as described in the classical-education lexicon. See the Six Essential Elements documents for the relevant keyword indicators.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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